

You should also be willing to spend some time marketing your blog. These approaches are more fully covered in chapter five. Only consider paid advertisements if you have a serious plan in monetising your Web site. However, the most basic technique, which is free except for the time you spend, is to visit other blogs of interest and get involved in the comments section there. Most comments sections provide a field to leave your Web site address. Participants in the comments section who like what you say may follow back through your link for more information about your blog.

Do not, unless the conversation warrants it blindly post links back to your blog. This is considered as bad etiquette and many blog owners will remove such links. This is what is known as comment spam. For example, if a blog is discussing politics, do not drop into the comments section and say something like “Please visit my ice cream blog at xyz.com”. Keep the comments meaningful and only point to content on your site if you feel that this will be better illustrated by your post on the subject.

When you find a blog post that you particularly like and wish to write a post on it yourself, make it a point to leave a track back link on the author’s original post. A trackback provides a convenient method to leave links to your blog on other blogs with similar content. Similarly, visitors who refer to a post on your blog can leave trackback links on your site. Trackbacks and links from other Web sites help in improving search engines. Luckily, or unluckily—depending on how you look at it, the only way to get quality trackbacks and links to your blog goes back to the cardinal traffic building rule: provide quality content.

You can also consider taking part in blogging carnivals at <http://blogcarnival.com>. Blog carnivals are like a magazine listing of blogs on a similar topic in one convenient location. Having one of your relevant blog posts included in a carnival can help increase the visibility of your blog as well as provide an opportunity for attracting fresh visitors.